

Josh Wright

English Composition 2

Dr. Russ

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### Reflective Essay

Our first essay was the fiction essay. I earned a relatively low grade initially, which I believe to be due to a lack of focus and attention because I was in the process of moving homes. I do not believe it was a lack of effort, my mind was just not in the right place.

When revising the essay, I was very disappointed in myself for not catching all the critical errors I had made. I corrected almost everything, from the header to the conclusion. I had to space out my paragraphs, add more detail, and rewrite a lot of it for clarity. I also failed to create a works cited page, which in return lost me a lot of points on the essay. I did not give up however, I did have to reeducate myself by reviewing my English composition 1 essays. Once I made the corrections, I made a 90% which I am very thankful for.

The second essay we worked on was the poetry essay, which I really enjoyed doing. I got a decent grade, though I also missed out on some points due to lack of attention to detail. In this essay I forgot to add my intext citations which happens to be one of the most important details within the essay to prevent the essay from being plagiarized.

In my opinion the second essay was much easier to write, I got my mind back on track, and refamiliarized with the content. Overall, I enjoyed both essays very much. While it is a possibility that the second essay was not easier, I was able to get on track.

Looking at my *Hamlet* essay, this essay was a bit challenging, more so tedious. I have a terrible memory, so I had to reread the material several times to make sure what I was saying was true, or debatable. I will say that this course did prepare me well for this essay, I believe I could not have done it before accomplishing the initial two essays. The two initial essays paved the way and opened my mind to be able to complete the *Hamlet* essay.

Overall, my writing has improved tremendously though this course. I have learned that all the small details matter the most to be able to show the big picture. While I still have quite a bit I need to improve on, such as intext citations, and a works cited page, I believe I am a lot more advanced in my writing ability's then English Composition 1.

I believe I should pass this course, based on the grades I achieved throughout this semester. While in my opinion, a test does not show one's true knowledge, I believe a test shows the ability to retain knowledge. Though I have made my fair number of mistakes, I did learn from them, and I will utilize the things I have learned to advance me in my career, as well as in my college life.

Professor Russ, I appreciate everything you have done for me as well as the rest of my peers, I enjoyed your class the most, and will certainly take another course that you are teaching if I am able. I truly learned a lot though this course and am very thankful.